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FUNDRAISING



NeoLogic wants to build more energy-efficient CPUs for AI data centers

When **NeoLogic** started building its more energy-efficient CPUs for AI servers, folks in the industry told its founders Avi Messica and Ziv Leshem that their idea wasn't viable.

"Most of the people that we have met say it's impossible," Messica told TechCrunch. "Some of them told us, at the time, that the innovation is impossible because you cannot innovate in logic synthesis. You can't innovate in circuit design. It's too mature."

Israel-based NeoLogic nevertheless set out to prove them wrong, and the fabless semiconductor startup has been building a server CPU that uses more simplified logic — how a chip processes information — with fewer transistors and logic gates to run faster while requiring less power.

NeoLogic was founded in 2021 by Messica, CEO, and Leshem, who together have 50 years of experience in the semiconductor industry. Leshem spent decades working on chip design at companies like Intel and Synopsis, while Messica focused on circuit design and the manufacturing side.

IMAGE CREDITS: NEOLOGIC

"We co-founded this company more than four years ago because Moore's law was dead," Messica said, referring to the 1960s observation that the number of transistors on microchips doubles every two years.

Around a decade ago, Messica said, companies stopped trying to scale transistors down in size, because transistors had gotten so small, there wasn't much more progress to be made there.

But, he says, NeoLogic wasn't convinced. The startup is working with two hyperscaler partners on the design of the server CPUs, but Messica would not disclose their names. The company plans to have a single-core test chip by the end of the year and hopes to get its server CPUs into data centers by 2027.

The advertisement for Mercury features a stylized graphic of a person surfing on a large, swirling wave. The wave is composed of concentric, colorful rings in shades of purple, blue, and orange. The Mercury logo, a circular emblem with a stylized 'M', is in the top left corner. The text "MERCURY" is in the top right. The main headline reads "It's more than banking." and the sub-headline reads "It's reading the break from one dashboard." At the bottom, a black box contains white text stating: "Mercury is a financial technology company, not a bank. Banking services provided through Choice Financial Group, Column N.A., and Evolve Bank & Trust; Members FDIC."

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NeoLogic recently raised a \$10 million Series A round led by KOMPAS VC with participation from M Ventures, Maniv Mobility, and lool Ventures. The company will use the funds to expand its engineering team and continue developing its CPUs.

The funding round comes as data centers are straining existing energy resources with no relief in sight. The ongoing AI boom has [data center power usage expected to double](#) in just the next four years.

Messica hopes that NeoLogic's energy-saving potential will help make its server CPUs too attractive for the market to ignore.

"It affects everything," Messica said of the potential energy savings. "If you talk about next-generation data centers, it affects the construction costs; it affects the amount of capital that you'll invest because you can shave off roughly 30% of the cost. And it affects the water usage. It has an impact on society, and basically that was our vision roughly five years ago."

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Becca is a senior writer at TechCrunch that covers venture capital trends and startups. She previously covered the same beat for Forbes...

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IMAGE CREDITS: PARADIGM

STARTUPS

Why Paradigm built a spreadsheet with an AI agent in every cell

Rebecca Szkutak — 8:00 AM PDT · August 18, 2025

Anna Monaco has been building AI agents since before the term “AI agents” was even a thing. After building numerous chatbots, she started looking for other types of interfaces that made sense for AI agents and landed on spreadsheets.

"I had this personal pattern, and I noticed that a lot of other people had this pattern, of putting very important CRM data in spreadsheets just because it was the most flexible thing," Monaco told TechCrunch. "But it was actually a pain to maintain. There's so much manual work involved. So [I] just went down this rabbit hole of building a product for myself and wanted to reimagine what a spreadsheet could look like with the full power of LLMs."

The result was [Paradigm](#), an AI-powered spreadsheet equipped with more than 5,000 AI agents. Users can assign different prompts to individual columns and cells, and individual AI agents will crawl the internet to find and fill out the needed information.

Paradigm works with AI models from Anthropic, OpenAI, and Google's Gemini, Monaco said, and supports model switching.

"We want to support every single model because we want our users to be able to have the highest reasoning outputs when they need it, but also the cheapest outputs," Monaco said. "It's just a constant cycle of evaluating different models, working closely with model providers to make sure our limits are high enough, and then giving some of that power to our users."

The company launched a small closed beta preview in late 2024 and has been iterating on the product using customer feedback. Paradigm attracts users ranging from consultants to sales professionals and finance folks and operates on a subscription model with tiers based on usage. Paradigm counts the consulting firm EY, AI chip startup Etched, and AI coding company Cognition as early customers.

Paradigm is now releasing its product to the public and announcing that it raised a \$5 million seed round led by General Catalyst. The company has raised \$7 million to date. Monaco said the funding will go toward executing on the company's "extremely aggressive product roadmap."

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“The interesting thing that happened when we fundraised is some people we pitched just kept on using and paying for the product,” Monaco said. “I think that was a cool part of it. We found a lot of value from it internally and our investors, not even just our investors — other investors that we talked to — are still using it.”

Paradigm isn't the only company looking to give spreadsheets an AI upgrade. [Quadratic](#), which has raised more than \$6 million in venture funding, is a 3-year-old startup with a similar goal. Legacy companies like Google and Microsoft are also adding AI tools to their spreadsheet applications.

Monaco said that she doesn't really consider the competition because Paradigm doesn't think of itself as an AI-powered spreadsheet. She said she thinks of it as a new AI-powered workflow that happens to be in the familiar form of a spreadsheet but won't necessarily stay that way forever.

“What I'm seeing in the most popular AI products now is this fine balance between present and future,” Monaco said. “How do you build something that is really powerful and generates a lot of value now but also sets you up really well for the future? That's the question that I asked myself a year ago when I was starting the company.”

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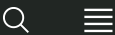


US spy chief says UK has dropped its Apple backdoor demand

Lorenzo Franceschi- 7:25 AM PDT · August 19,

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protected encrypted data of American citizens and encroached on our civil liberties,” [Gabbard wrote in a post on X](#). She also claimed that she worked along President Donald Trump and Vice President JD Vance in the negotiations.

Over the past few months, I’ve been working closely with our partners in the UK, alongside [@POTUS](#) and [@VP](#), to ensure Americans' private data remains private and our Constitutional rights and civil liberties are protected.

As a result, the UK has agreed to drop its mandate for...

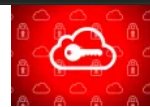
— DNI Tulsi Gabbard (@DNIGabbard) [August 19, 2025](#)

This is the latest (and unexpected) development in a months-long saga that saw the British government secretly demanding Apple grant its authorities access — essentially asking for a [backdoor](#) — to the encrypted data of iCloud users, effectively anywhere in the world, particularly those who turn on [Advanced Data Protection](#) (or ADP), an opt-in security feature. ADP [turns on end-to-end encryption](#) for iCloud, meaning only the user can access their files stored on Apple’s cloud servers.

The existence of the legal demand was first reported by [The Washington Post](#) in February, which was made under the [U.K.’s Investigatory Powers Act 2016](#), also known as the Snoopers’ Charter. The request [sparked outrage and condemnation](#) from privacy and security experts worldwide, who argued that if the U.K. government obtained what it wanted, it would weaken privacy for the whole world, and also open the door for more governments to make similar demands, even in other companies’ technologies.

[Apple initially responded by removing ADP from the U.K.](#), meaning new users couldn’t turn it on. The company also said it would give guidance to existing users who “will eventually need to disable this security feature.”

In the meantime, Apple also [reportedly challenged the backdoor mandate](#) in court, a case that was initially secret but [was then ruled to be held in public](#).



US spy chief says UK has dropped its Apple backdoor demand

Lorenzo Franceschi-Bicchierai
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Apple and the U.K. Home Office, which initiated the demand on behalf of the British government, did not respond to requests for comment.



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Olivia Coleman, the press secretary of the U.S. Office of the Director of National Intelligence, referred to a February letter to Sen. Wyden and Rep. Biggs.

Apple previously told TechCrunch that the company has “never built a backdoor or master key” to any of its products or services and it “never will.”

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Senior Reporter, Cybersecurity |

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IMAGE CREDITS: EIGHT SLEEP / EIGHT SLEEP

FUNDRAISING



Eight Sleep raises \$100M to expand its AI-powered sleep tech

Kate Park — 3:00 AM PDT · August 19, 2025

Roughly [one in three adults in the U.S. regularly gets insufficient sleep](#), driving demand for tools that can monitor, analyze, and enhance rest. [Eight Sleep](#), founded in 2014, offers AI-powered sleep tech products that promise to transform your bed into a preventive health device.

The New York-based startup announced Tuesday that it raised a fresh \$100 million round from investors such as HSG, Valor Equity Partners, Founders Fund, Y Combinator and athletes

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including Ferrari F1 driver Charles Leclerc, and Zak Brown, who is the CEO of McLaren F1.

With this round, Eight Sleep has raised roughly \$260 million total, Pitchbook estimates. It previously raised an \$86 million Series C in 2021 by investors who assigned it a [\\$500 million post-money valuation](#). Eight Sleep said its valuation has doubled since its last round, but didn't disclose specifics.

"If we successfully execute our AI roadmap, launch internationally, and develop condition-specific interventions, achieving unicorn status will naturally follow," Alexandra Zatarain, co-founder and CMO of Eight Sleep, told TechCrunch.

Eight offers smart mattresses that integrate software and AI to track and enhance sleep quality. Its flagship product, Pod, offers features like measuring sleep stages, heart rate, breathing patterns, and movement. Using these insights, it automatically adjusts temperature, elevation, and firmness. It can also detect snoring and automatically elevate the base in response, according to the company.

The company has generated more than \$500 million in Pod sales, expanded its revenue tenfold since launching the product in 2019, and collected insights from over one billion hours of recorded sleep data, it says.

Eight, which employs just over 100 full-time staff, is now expanding beyond the Pod with its Sleep Agent, an AI-driven system that leverages large language models to create thousands of digital twins for each user and predict outcomes, with the goal of optimizing nightly recovery. This approach shifts sleep technology from reactive tracking to proactive, personalized intervention, said Zatarain.

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The sleep tech market features a range of competitors, from wearable devices such as Oura, Fitbit, and Apple, to medical-focused companies like ResMed, as well as smart mattress and sleep surface makers, including Sleep Number and ChiliSleep.

Eight's core differentiator, Autopilot, "builds a personal blueprint from night one, then adapts continuously, accounting for seasonality, travel, stress, training, illness, or even a bad night before. And it works independently for each side of the bed," Zatarain said.

The startup plans to use the new funding to accelerate its growth in the medical sector, building on the Pod's health-monitoring capabilities. With the introduction of Health Check, the system can monitor cardiovascular and respiratory patterns with up to 99% accuracy without the need for wearable devices, according to the company.

"We're not replacing your doctor, but we are giving you nightly, high-accuracy health monitoring so you can act early if trends shift. Over time, this data can complement medical care," Zatarain said.

Eight's recently launched [Hot Flash Mode](#) employs AI-driven cooling to relieve menopause symptoms. It is also working on contactless solutions for sleep apnea. The company is pursuing FDA approval and will utilize the Pod's real-time biometric monitoring to deliver personalized interventions.

Eight Sleep currently ships to over 30 countries—including Canada, the UK and EU nations, Australia, Mexico, and the UAE—and is now planning to expand into China. The CMO told TechCrunch that China, as one of the world's largest consumer markets, is seeing a rise in a health-conscious middle class that prioritizes sleep and overall wellness.

Regarding sensitive health data, Zatarain said the company complies with each locale's regulations, including for data storage.

“Privacy is foundational. All data is encrypted, never sold, and fully private. We comply with GDPR and CCPA, and unlike many devices, we don’t use microphones. Our biometric sensors are embedded in the bed surface — no wearables, no invasiveness, just passive, high-accuracy insights,” Zatarain said.

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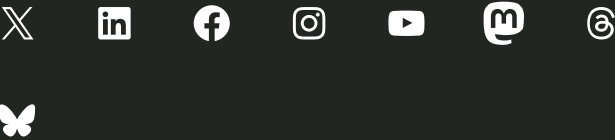
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Reporter, Asia |

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